Humanitarian intervention remains critical to mitigating more extreme levels of food insecurity in 2018

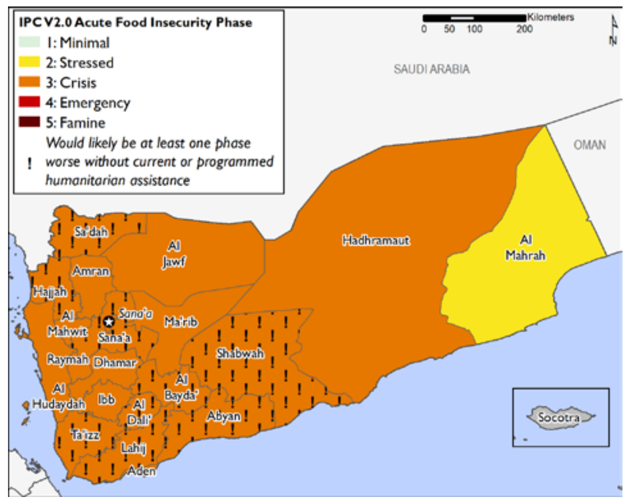
KEY MESSAGES

- Large populations in Yemen continue to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) acute food insecurity. As worst-affected households begin to exhaust their coping capacity, populations may begin to move into Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) even in the absence of additional disruptions. In a worst-case scenario, significant declines in commercial imports below requirement levels and conflict that cuts populations off from trade and humanitarian assistance for an extended period could drive food security outcomes in line with Famine (IPC Phase 5).

- Large-scale humanitarian assistance continues to play an important role in reducing the severity of acute food insecurity outcomes in Yemen. In 2017, the humanitarian community reached on average nearly six million beneficiaries, and that number is increasing in 2018. Current funding for emergency food assistance in Yemen is expected to be sufficient to provide assistance at current levels only through May 2018.

- Yemen's main seaports (Al Hudaydah, Salif, Aden, Al Mukalla) remain open and inflows of commercial and humanitarian imports have continued into March. However, import levels are broadly below pre-blockade levels and less than monthly food and fuel import requirements.

Current food security outcomes, February 2018



Source: *FEWS NET*

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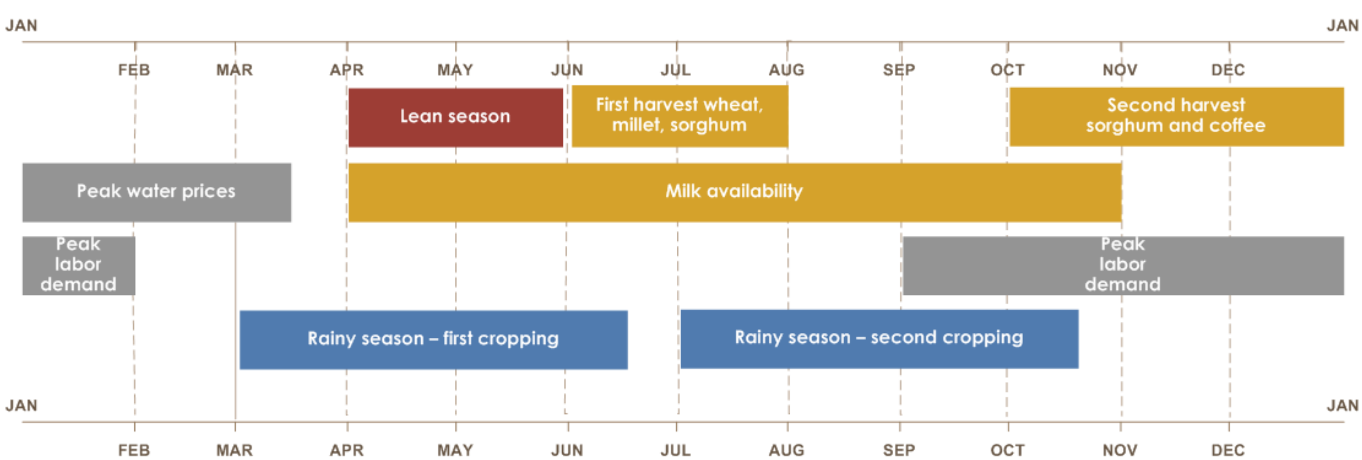
SEASONAL CALENDAR FOR A TYPICAL YEAR



Source: *FEWS NET*

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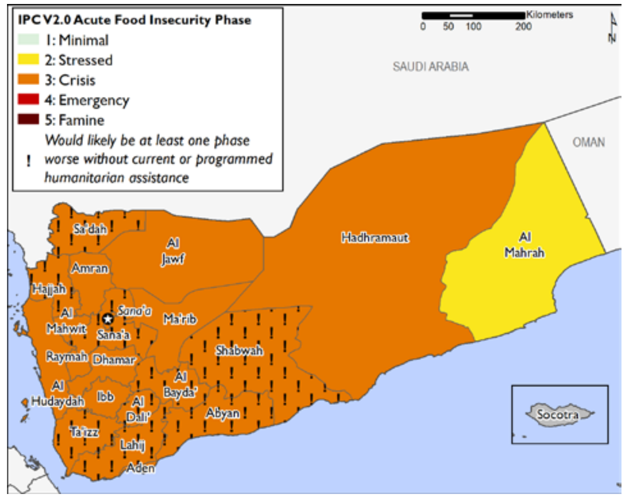
National Overview

Current Situation

Displacement

More than two million Yemenis remain internally displaced due to conflict, with nearly 90 percent displaced for more than one year. According to UNHCR, as of 9 February, about 85,000 people had been displaced since December 2017 due to the ongoing conflict, mostly in Yemen's west coast and in particular from the districts of Al Khawkhah, Al Garrahi and Hays in southern Hudaydah, and Mokha and Mawza in Ta'izz. More than 21,000 of those fleeing violence from the west coast have fled to Abyan, more than 12,300 and 13,600 have been newly displaced within Al Hudaydah and Ta'izz governorates, respectively, and others have fled to Lahj, Al Mahrah, Aden, Ibb, Dhamar, Hadramaut, and Shabwah.

Projected food security outcomes, February to May 2018

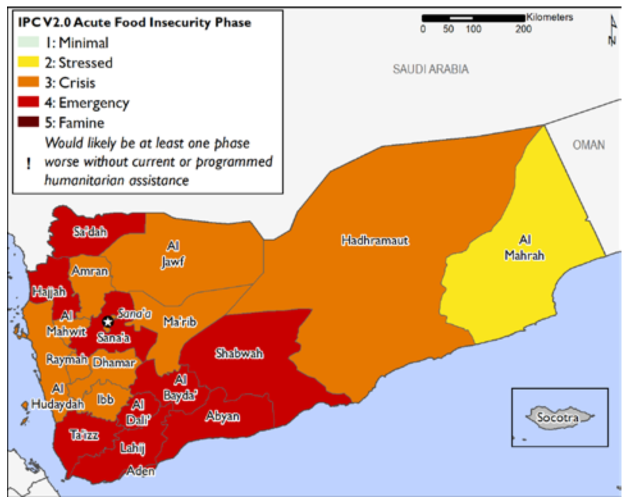


Source: *FEWS NET*

Macroeconomic conditions

The macroeconomic situation in Yemen continues to deteriorate. According the Ministry of Planning and International Cooperation (MOPIC), Yemen's gross domestic product (GDP) decreased by about 10.9 percent in 2017 as a result of the ongoing war, displacement, emigration from Yemen, and loss of confidence in the future of the national economy. The decline in exports, as well as oil and gas production, are some of the major factors responsible for the economic downturn. The severe liquidity crisis in the banking system is also a contributing factor. The public budget crisis has resulted in unpaid salaries for most public employees and retirees and the disruption of public service programs.

Projected food security outcomes, June to September 2018



Source: *FEWS NET*

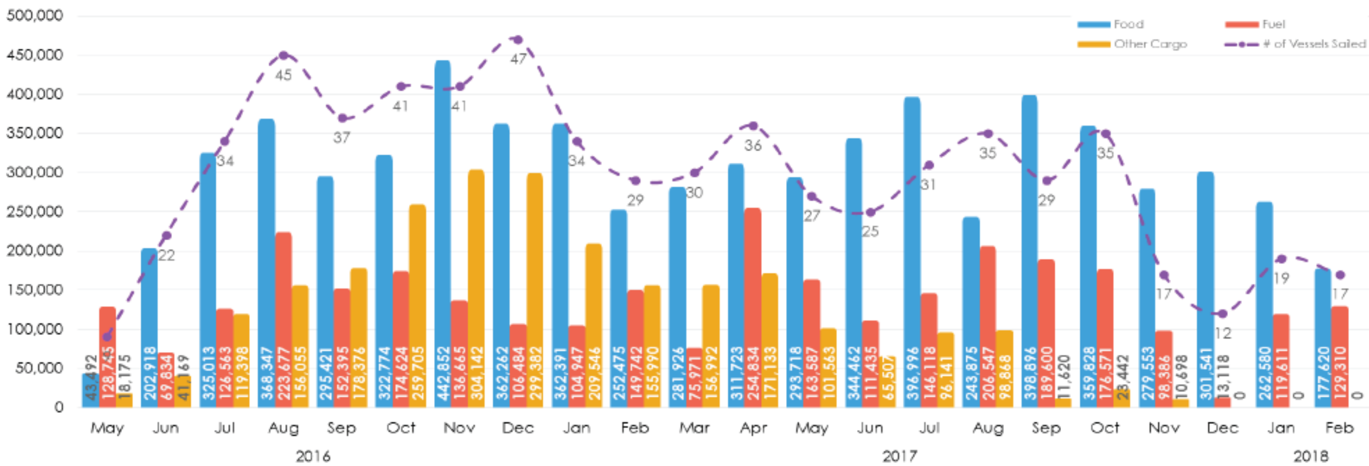
FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

The Yemeni Riyal initially gained in strength after Saudi Arabia announced the deposit of $2 billion USD in the Central Bank of Yemen, strengthening from 505 YER/USD to 425 YER/USD. However, it has since resumed depreciation and was again worth 480 YER/USD by the fourth week of February according to exchange rate data collected in Sana'a City. Following the deposit, the Central Bank of Yemen in Aden disseminated a circular setting the exchange rate to 379 YER/USD and requesting exchange bureaus commit to that rate. Nonetheless, the value of the Yemeni Rial has continued to decline and is now worth about 40 percent of its value compared to this time last year.

Imports

In a typical year, over 90 percent of food supplies and 80 percent of cereal supplies in Yemen are imported (FAOSTAT), mostly via commercial marine imports. The national cereal import requirement in 2017 was estimated at about 4.3 million tons, including 3.2 million tons of wheat and 400,000 tons of rice (FAO). Data from the Food Security Technical Secretariat (FSTS) suggests about 3.58 million tons of wheat and 477,945 tons of rice were imported between January and December 2017, with 60 percent, 28 percent, and 8 percent of the total imports coming through Al Hudaydah & Salif, Aden and Mukalla ports respectively. Data from UNVIM (Figure 1) suggests imports were slightly less, but still close to requirement levels. Ship arrival information monitored by FEWS NET suggests that the number of arrivals of bulk carriers, which typically transport most staple cereals, in the ports of Al Hudaydah, Salif, Aden, and Al Mukalla slightly decreased in 2017 compared to 2016 (-9.7 percent) but was similar to 2014.

Figure 1. Monthly quantities discharged (in tons) by type of cargo

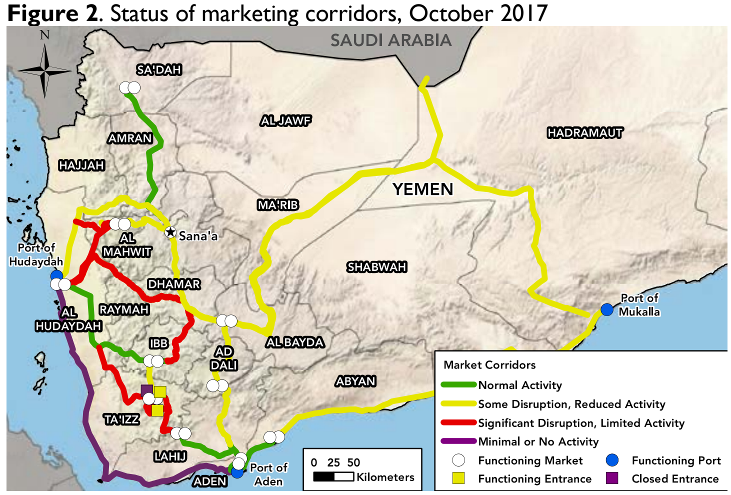


Source: *UNVIM*

Yemen's major seaports remain open following the blockade on imports in late 2017, but imports of fuel – and possibly food – remain well below required levels. According to UNVIM, only 262,580 tons of food and 119,612 tons of fuel were discharged at the ports of Al Hudaydah and Salif in January, a 29% decrease for food and a 38% decrease for fuel respectively compared to the average monthly quantity imported during the six months (May to October) prior to the blockade. The decrease is attributed to the impact of the blockade on the shipping community and the long clearance procedure. The average processing time for vessels entering Yemen's Red Sea ports in January 2018 increased 4.6 days; on average vessels are taking approximately 15 days to complete the full process of obtaining clearances, entering the ports, discharging, and exiting the ports which is resulting in increased shipping and demurrage costs. The 30-day extension which the Saudi-led Coalition announced on January 19 to keep Al Hudaydah and Salif port open to all commercial and humanitarian imports has expired but imports appear to be continuing.

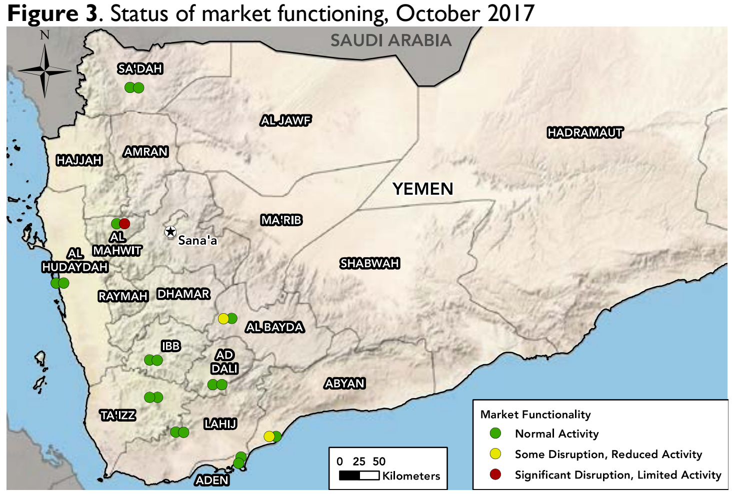
Recent reporting by WFP has also raised concern that food imports are far enough below required levels to significantly impact food availability in the medium term. In early February 2018, WFP reported that stocks of staple cereals (including wheat grain, wheat flour, and rice) in Yemen totaled approximately 784,000 MT, 30 percent lower than levels reported in the Food Security and Agriculture Cluster's Food Availability Brief from November 1, 2017, prior to the blockade. By mid-February, WFP reported that stock levels were at approximately 630,000 MT, another 20 percent decline from just a few weeks earlier. Although it is unclear whether the information collected by WFP and the FSAC are directly comparable, reports of declines in stock levels to this degree are a source of concern.

Figure 2. Status of marketing corridors, October 2017



Source: *Rapid assessments*

Figure 3. Status of market functioning, October 2017

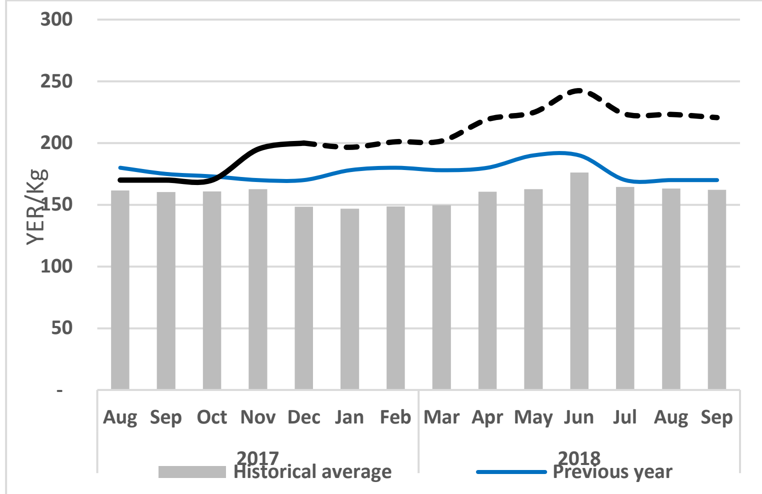


Source: *Rapid assessments*

Internal trade

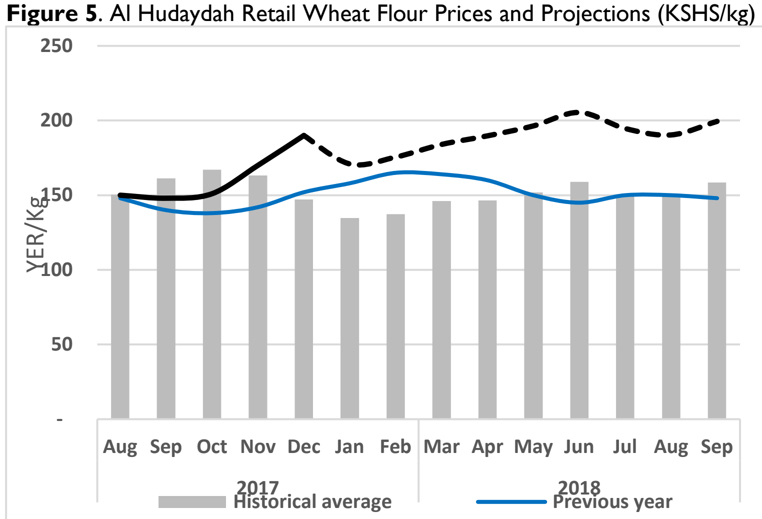
Conflict and insecurity has made road access more difficult in Yemen, with the Yemen Logistics Cluster reporting in mid-January 2018 that major roads were closed or difficult to access in the southwest (Al Hudaydah and Ta'izz governorates), the northwest (Hajjah, Sa'ada, and the western part of Al Jawf governorates) and central areas (Al Bayda, Marib, and Sana'a governorates). Compared to previous reporting in December by the Logistics Cluster, road access has improved in the southern part of Al Hudaydah governorate, and in Hajjah and Sa'ada governorates but has worsened in Al Bayda, Marib, and Sana'a governorates. Rapid assessments in October 2017 had indicated some or significant disruptions on most major roads and minimal or no activity on the coastal road between Al Hudaydah City and Aden (Figure 2). Although market activity is reported to be normal, with the exception of some disruptions reported in Abyan, Al Bayda and Al Mahwit governorates (Figure 3), a study from the Cash and Market Working Group (CMWG) conducted in August/September 2017 suggests that increasing fuel costs were already a concern even before the blockade in late 2018 further restricted fuel supply.

Figure 4. Sana'a City Retail Wheat Flour Prices and Projections (KSHS/kg)



Source: *FEWS NET Estimates based on data from WFP*

Figure 5. Al Hudaydah Retail Wheat Flour Prices and Projections (KSHS/kg)



Source: *FEWS NET Estimates based on data from WFP*

While the availability of commodities on markets did not yet change significantly between December 2017 and January 2018, availability had already declined significantly across most monitored markets compared to previous months according to WFP Market Watch Reports. In January 2018, wheat flour was rated as "sparsely available" (found in at least half of the visits to all markets of the governorate) in most governorates in Yemen except in Abyan, Aden, Al Mahra, Al Jawf, Hadramout, Lahj and Socotra where it was rated as "available" (found available at every visit in all markets of the governorate). Rapid assessments

previous to the blockade in October 2017 had indicated that wheat flour was considered available in Abyan, Aden, Al Hudaydah, Al Mahwit and Lahij, somewhat available in Ad Dali, Ibb, Sa'ada and Ta'izz and somewhat scarce in Al Bayda.

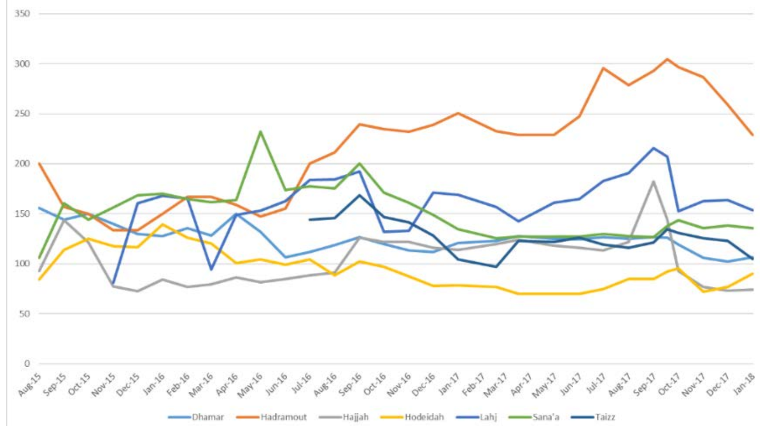
Fuel (diesel, gasoline and cooking oil) was "sparsely available" on over 80 percent of the markets assessed by WFP in December 2017 and January 2018 despite recent improved levels of imports. Earlier in 2017, WFP had assessed fuel as being "available" or "widely available" on about 70 percent of markets. Diesel, gasoline, cooking oil availability was most concerning in Aden, Al Hudaydah, Ibb, Ta'izz, Ad Dali, Al Bayda, Al Mahwit, Lahj, Abyan, and Sa'ada where it was somewhat available or scarce.

Fuel prices

Given the recent improvements in fuel imports, fuel prices on most markets were either stable or decreased between December 2017 and January 2018, but they still remain more than double pre-conflict levels. The exception is in Hadramout

Governorate, where in January fuel prices increased significantly compared to December. The highest fuel prices in the country were observed in the following governorates: Raymah for cooking gas, Marib and Ta'izz for diesel and Marib for gasoline. Fuel prices have been high and volatile in Yemen since March 2015 as a result of the ongoing conflict and reduced imports, and despite low global fuel prices. Increased fuel prices are negatively affecting typical livelihood activities, such as agriculture, and contributing to increased prices of food and non-food commodities through higher transaction costs. High prices and limited availability, particularly in late 2017, also has constricted water access as many areas rely on pumping water for human use.

Figure 6. Average terms of trade for goats to wheat flour (kilograms of wheat flour/goat)



Source: *FSTS-FSIS price data*

Wheat flour prices

Wheat flour prices remain above average across major markets in Yemen, and have remained stable or increased on most markets in recent months. According to WFP price monitoring, on the major import and consumption markets of Sana'a City (Figure 4), Aden, and Al Hudaydah (Figure 5) wheat flour prices were 45 to 70 percent higher in January 2018 than in the months prior to the start of conflict in March 2015, and were 25 to 30 percent higher than in October 2017 before the blockade. Wheat flour prices in January 2018 were highest in Shabwah and Ta'izz at 265 YER/Kg and 250 YER/Kg, respectively, and the lowest in Socotra at 150 YER/Kg. In general, wheat flour prices in almost all governorates continue to closely follow trends observed in the major import and consumption markets, except on Al Ma'effer market in Ta'izz and Attaq market in Shabwah, where prices remain volatile.

Income sources

The persistent conflict and water scarcity continue to significantly compromise livelihoods and production in the agricultural sector. According to FAO, almost all governorates are reporting shortages and high prices of agricultural inputs. In addition, remotely sensed weather information suggests below-average and poorly distributed rains during the 2017 agricultural season. Total cereal production in 2017 is forecast at 335,000 tons, about 8 percent below last year's harvest and about half of the five-year average. Specialists working in agricultural offices in Ibb and Ta'izz expect even larger reductions in agricultural production in the highlands. According to FAO, many rural households appear to be increasingly relying on casual labor opportunities as their main source of income although in most conflict-affected areas, hired agricultural labor tends to be replaced by other casual labor in order to cope with the increased costs of production. FAO also reports that approximately 45 percent of households have reduced their livestock herd sizes either intentionally to cover other needs, such as health and food, or due to animal diseases. Livestock to cereal terms of trade declined significantly following the blockade, and remain slightly below-average on most markets (Figure 6). Income from sales of produce has also declined as a result of the lack of marketing channels, resulting in depressed farm-gate prices and higher sale prices in the urban areas.

Household incomes from other sources remain well below average. Many government employees continue to not receive regular salaries or pensions due to the Central Banks' lack of adequate financial resources. Rapid assessments conducted in October 2017 found that remittance offices were functioning in urban areas but that liquidity issues limited the ability of some offices to process these remittances. Between August and November 2017, UNICEF reached more than 1.3 million households under the Social Welfare Fund cash program. The average cash transfer was YER 15,000/quarter. The next round of transfers under the program is expected in March.

Food sources

Market purchase using cash or credit continues to be an important food sources for most, although access remains significantly restricted by high food prices and low incomes. Humanitarian assistance and assistance from family, friends, and neighbors is also increasingly an important food sources over the past year in many governorates.

Partner reports continue to suggest that households are increasingly relying on food donations, buying food on credit and resorting to other consumption-based coping strategies. According to a rapid needs assessment conducted by Human Appeal in September 2017 in randomly selected villages in Abyan, Hajjah and Sana'a governorates, credit purchases were the main source of food for over half of the households and the leading cause of household debt. The majority of households surveyed also reported relying on less preferred and expensive food (75 percent) and borrowing food or relying on help from friends or relatives (84 percent). Similarly, a rapid assessment conducted by CARE in November in the Ash-Shamaytan, Sama and Al Maafer districts in Ta'izz reported that a majority of households are relying on a less preferred and less expensive food (94 percent) and borrowing food, or relying on help from friends or relatives (71 percent). Key food sources for IDP households are humanitarian assistance and donations by the host community, according to assessments conducted between September and December 2017 by Action Against Hunger and the Abs Development Organization in Abyan, Aden, Hajjah, and Lahj.

Humanitarian assistance

Large-scale humanitarian assistance continues to play an important role in reducing higher levels of food insecurity outcomes. In December 2017 and January 2018, WFP reached over 6.5 and 6.9 million people, respectively, with emergency food assistance. In addition to WFP, local and international actors continue to operate food distribution or cash transfer programs throughout the country. On January 22, the Saudi-led Coalition launched the Yemen Comprehensive Humanitarian Operations (YCHO) plan, committing to support humanitarian operations and improve and expand existing infrastructure to enhance the flow and delivery of humanitarian aid and commercial goods.

Humanitarian movements and operations have been increasingly limited by conflict since December 2017. The humanitarian response has been primarily delayed by violence in Aden, Al Hudaydah, Sana'a City and Ta'izz governorates, although routine humanitarian activities have also been affected in other governorates. For example, vaccination and field missions in Ad Dali and Lahj governorates were temporarily halted as a result of the violence in Aden. In addition, some humanitarian organizations suspended their operations in Al Hudaydah City, Amran, Hajjah, Sa'ada, Ta'izz City, and parts of Al Jawf when armed clashes and airstrikes escalated in Sana'a City in the first week of December 2017, where many of their warehouses are located, and resumed immediately after the clashes stopped in mid-December 2017.

Cholera and diphtheria outbreaks

The weekly number of new cholera cases has been decreasing in Yemen for 25 consecutive weeks and the weekly proportion of severe cases has significantly decreased, representing now only 11 percent of the admitted cases. Between April 27, 2017 and February 25, 2018, 1,069,197 suspected cases were reported. However, as fuel shortages continue to limit water availability, and as cholera is linked to poor water sanitation and hygiene, further increases in the cholera caseload are possible.

The diphtheria outbreak continues to spread, affecting 179 districts in 20 governorates in March 2018, according to Yemen's Ministry of Public Health and Population (MOPHP). Over 1,265 suspected cases and 73 associated deaths have been recorded since mid-August 2017, more than half in the governorates of Ibb and Al Hudaydah, mainly due to low vaccination rates and poor access to medical care.

Current food security outcomes

In general, WFP's mobile Vulnerability and Assessment Mapping (mVAM) data suggest food security outcomes are similar to previous months or last year's levels in most governorates. Between November 2017 and January 2018, WFP's mVAM surveys found that, on average, more than 20 percent of households reported "poor" Food Consumption Scores (FCS) in 14 governorates (Abyan, Al Bayda, Ad Dali, Al Jawf, Al Mahwit, Amran, Dhamar, Hajjah, Ibb, Lahj, Marib, Raymah, Sanaa, and Ta'izz). WFP's mVAM reports have consistently indicated that a higher proportion of IDP respondents report poor FCS in comparison to non-displaced populations. Meanwhile, the overall use of negative food-related coping strategies remained stable between November and January, indicative of no significant improvement in household food security after the suspension of the blockade.

Approximately three quarters of respondents reported purchasing less expensive food and limiting portion sizes while 60 percent reduced the number of meals and restricted adult consumption, and more than half borrowed food.

Assumptions

The most likely scenario for the February to September 2018 period is based on the following national level assumptions:

- **Conflict:** For the purpose of this scenario, FEWS NET assumes that recent increases in conflict will be maintained and will continue to drive increases in displacement through at least September 2018.
- **Economy:** For the most likely scenario, FEWS NET assumes that the current macroeconomic crisis will continue. More specifically:
    - **Central Bank**: The Central Bank's current split in management will continue. The Central Bank will not receive any additional major funding from external donors and will not provide credit to the private sector for food importation during the scenario period.
    - **Oil Exports:** Oil exports will not return to pre-conflict levels during the scenario period.
    - **Foreign reserves:** Despite Saudi Arabia's recent deposits in Yemen's Central Bank, foreign reserves within the country will continue to decline compared to current levels, given the assumptions of significantly reduced oil exports and no additional funding from external donors.
    - **Exchange rate**: Given the decline in foreign reserves, the YER will continue to depreciate against foreign currencies due to the inability of the two central banks to intervene due to operational constraints and the shortage of hard currency.
    - **Liquidity constraints:** Liquidity constraints at banks within Yemen will continue to worsen and will limit general economic activities and complicate import activities.
- **Imports:** Cargo will continue arriving into Al Hudaydah, Salif, Aden, and Al Mukalla ports. Cargo arriving into Al Mokha will remain limited. While large traders will continue to find alternative methods of accessing foreign currency to continue operations, import levels will likely remain volatile and transaction costs associated with these imports will increase. Informal food flows across land borders will also continue at status quo levels, but their transport into the western areas of Yemen will remain difficult due to civil insecurity and difficult market access.
- **Government salaries and the Social Welfare Fund:** Many government employees will continue not to receive regular salaries or pensions due to the Central Banks' lack of adequate financial resources. UNICEF/World Bank are planning to conduct in March 2018 a second round of transfers to 1.5 million households (approximately 8 million people) who were former beneficiaries of the Social Welfare Fund.
- **Internal trade flows:** Active fighting, damaged transportation infrastructure, high fuel prices, and additional security and transaction costs (e.g. commissions at checkpoints) will continue to complicate trade flows within the country. In the absence of additional information about the evolution of conflict, FEWS NET assumes that areas where trade flows will be particularly constrained will be the same areas where roads are currently closed, as shown by the Logistics Cluster's most recent access constraints map.
- **Market demand:** Demand from consumers will remain atypically low during the scenario period due to weak household purchasing power caused by below-average incomes and high levels of debt. However, purchasing power may improve temporarily at times during the scenario period as households receive erratic salary payments and/or cash transfers.
- **Wheat flour prices:** Given the recent improved import levels, wheat flour prices are largely expected to follow recent trends except in markets where they have been high and volatile since the start of the conflict, such as in Ta'izz and Shabwah. In these markets, prices will likely continue to be volatile moving forward. In general, prices are expected remain above average and above pre-conflict levels due to increased transaction costs and the continued depreciation of the Yemeni Riyal.
- **Fuel prices:** Given a tightening of supply and increased transaction costs for fuel imports, FEWS NET anticipates that fuel prices will remain high and volatile. Fuel prices and availability on the market will mostly be affected by conflict and import levels as domestic fuel production is likely to be able to meet only a third of domestic needs.

- **Agricultural production:** The seasonality of agricultural production varies depending on the zone in Yemen. However, in general, land preparations and planting activities of cereal crops will occur between February and June. Key harvest periods will then take place between July and the end of the outlook period in Central Highlands and the Eastern Plateau zones. Meanwhile, in southern upland and coastal areas, harvests will occur after the end of the outlook period in October/November. The first rainy season (March to May) is expected to be below average in terms of total cumulative rainfall for western coastal areas and average for the rest of the country. There is also increased likelihood for hotter-than-normal land surface temperatures across the country, during this period. Production will likely be below average due to a lack of availability and/or access to inputs and limited access to fields in conflict zones. Related agricultural labor opportunities will also be atypically low. Qat production, however, will continue to be generally average. Locusts may be present in coastal Red Sea areas and in the interior of Yemen (FAO) but will cause minimal damage.
- **Remittances:** Although remittance service offices will remain open in most urban areas, significant difficulties (ex. delays, closed offices, lack of liquidity) will limit the ability of households to receive remittances from abroad. This will result in below-average incomes from this source.
- **Fishing:** Based on seasonality information provided by the World Bank/FAO, fishing activities along Red Sea coastal areas will increase seasonally starting in March/April and continue through September but will remain well below average due to high fuel prices and civil insecurity. On the Gulf of Aden coast, peak fishing periods will include March/April and June to September.
- **Livestock sales:** Income from livestock sales will likely be below average from February to May as purchasing power will remain low and there are more livestock parasites and diseases. From June to August, income from livestock sales may increase compared to the current situation as two major Muslim holidays occur during this time. However, despite these relatively higher prices, reduced livestock assets caused by several years of food insecurity will limit household income from this source.
- **Incomes from other sources:** The deteriorating macroeconomic situation and conflict will disrupt household livelihoods across much of the country, resulting in below-average household incomes. The largest declines in incomes will be among IDP populations and households residing in intense conflict zones.
- **Nutrition:** Given expected difficulty in accessing food during the scenario period, acute malnutrition is expected to rise and remain above seasonally normal levels across much of the country. Based on historical data, SAM admissions to treatment programs are usually at their highest levels between November and January.
- **Cholera and diphtheria:** Ongoing fuel shortages will continue to limit the availability of clean water, as well as the functioning and delivery of vaccines and medical supplies to health centers and hospitals around the country. As a result, the spread of cholera and diphtheria is expected to continue through the scenario period.
- **Humanitarian assistance:** FEWS NET assumes that humanitarian partners will continue providing in-kind and commodity voucher assistance into May 2018. However, given an absence of information on the planned, funded, and likely status of humanitarian assistance from June to September 2018, no humanitarian assistance is assumed during the second half of the scenario period.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

The ongoing food security emergency in western Yemen is likely to continue to drive very high assistance needs through at least September 2018. The deteriorating macroeconomic situation and the persistence of conflict will continue to disrupt household livelihoods, limiting purchasing power and access to food. While harvests during the scenario period will provide some rural households with small food stocks, these stocks are not expected to have major impacts on food security outcomes given the small-scale nature of agricultural production in Yemen and the fact that these harvests will be below average. Household food access will likely further be constrained by higher than usual food prices. Under the most likely scenario, most areas of western Yemen will be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3), or would be at least one IPC Phase worse in the absence of planned, funded, and likely humanitarian assistance, and will therefore be classified in Crisis (IPC Phase 3!). Given that needs are significantly greater than current assistance programming, it is likely populations in some governorates will face Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes, among whom increased levels of acute malnutrition are likely. Even in the absence of additional disruptions, populations may begin to move into Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) as worst-affected households begin to exhaust their coping capacity. Meanwhile, in Al Mahrah governorate where on-the-ground fighting and airstrikes have been less intense than in western areas and household livelihoods and food consumption have been less impacted by fighting, outcomes are likely to remain in line with Stressed (IPC Phase 2) acute food insecurity.

IDP populations and poor households in conflict zones will likely continue to face the most severe food security outcomes. With the recent escalation of hostilities on Yemen's Red Sea Coast, displacement is likely to continue despite recent increases in humanitarian access to affected areas. Conditions for the displaced will vary based on location, depending on access to labor markets, support from the host community, access to humanitarian aid, and the functioning of local markets. However, in the areas most isolated and cut-off from trade by the conflict, many of the displaced are likely to enter or to remain in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) through at least September.

In a worst-case scenario, significant declines in commercial imports far below requirement levels and conflict that cuts populations off from trade would likely drive food security outcomes in line with Famine (IPC Phase 5). The rate with which the size of the population in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse increases in 2018 and 2019 would also intensify. The prospect of increased conflict that could damage port facilities at Al Hudaydah and Salif ports is particularly concerning. Al Hudaydah port is the entry point of about 70 percent of all food imports into Yemen. Given that imports by humanitarian actors currently make up less than one quarter of total formal cereal imports into Yemen, it is very unlikely that the humanitarian community or overland imports from neighboring countries would have the capacity to fill the very large import gaps that would exist in this scenario. This would drive major shortages on local markets and likely result in steep price increases, limiting household food access. Furthermore, increased conflict could drive additional displacement and cut populations off from trade, further limiting income-earning opportunities, driving even more severe price increases in local areas, and resulting in a rapid deterioration of food security outcomes.

AREAS OF CONCERN

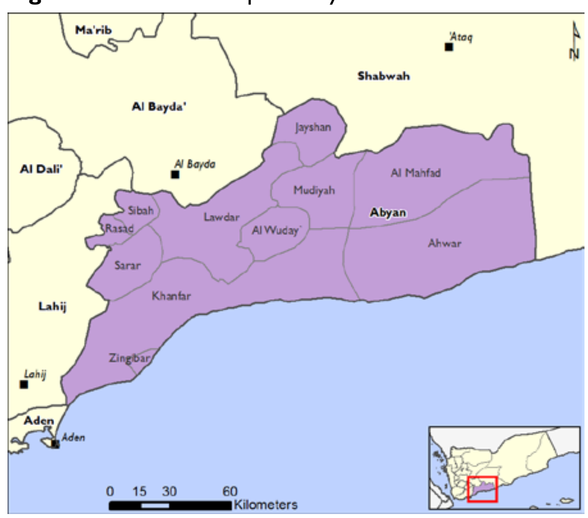
Abyan Governorate

Current Situation

Conflict and displacement

In Abyan, the level of insecurity has remained stable in recent months. Since October 2017, most fighting has taken place on the coastal area between Zinjibar and Shaqra, close to the border with Al Baydah, and in and around Al Mahfed. Security incidents have been erratic, and have included occasional shelling, armed clashes, air strikes and IED attacks.

Figure 7. Reference Map for Abyan Governorate



Source: *FEWS NET*

According to OCHA in February 2018, Abyan was hosting the highest share of the IDPs (3,091 households, or approximately 42 percent) who had fled the conflict in Ta'izz earlier in the year. UNHCR reported on February 9th that the majority of those fleeing violence from the west coast of Yemen are fleeing east to Abyan, where more than 21,000 IDPs are located. The 16th report of the Task Force for Population Movement (TFPM) in October indicated that approximately half of IDP households are living with relatives, one-third are living in rented accommodation, and about 10 percent are living in isolated and dispersed settlements. Three quarters of IDP households in Abyan have been living there for more than one year.

Trade, markets, and prices

In January 2018, WFP reported that all most major food products were available in Abyan, whereas red beans and all fuel commodities (cooking gas, diesel and petrol) were sparsely available. As in many other governorates of Yemen, the supply and availability of basic commodities significantly deteriorated compared to previous months. Rapid assessments conducted even prior to the blockade had found that stock levels of staple foods as well as market activity have decreased in Zinjibar's central market compared to February 2015 levels. However, livestock stocks and market activity seem to have increased compared to February 2015 levels in Lawdar's livestock market which is located close to the border with the Al Bayda governorate. Most major roads linking Abyan to other governorates remain open or open with difficult access.

Wheat flour prices in Zinjibar were approximately 46 percent above pre-conflict levels in January 2018 and had increased compared to the previous month by 18 percent, based on WFP price data. Wheat flour prices in Zinjibar remained relatively stable between July and November 2017, between 150 and 158 YER/kg, but then increased to 170 YER/kg in December 2017 and to 200 YER/kg in January 2018. Meanwhile, diesel and petrol prices were relatively stable between December 2017 and January 2018, but are 93 and 75 percent higher, respectively, than in January 2017.

Household livelihoods and incomes

The main sources of income for most of the poor households in Abyan have traditionally been agricultural labor and livestock sales but the prolonged conflict has disrupted households' livelihoods. Official agricultural production data indicates that the area of land dedicated for agricultural production and livestock production has been decreasing in Abyan since 2014. For example, the area of land dedicated to cereal production in 2016 has decreased by 17.6 percent compared to 2014, the production of goats estimated at 863,603 in 2016 has decreased by 3.2 percent compared to 2014 and the production of sheep estimated at 535,625 in 2016 has decreased by 8.1 percent compared to 2014. Rapid assessments conducted in October 2017 also show that income from agricultural labor has decreased compared to 2014, whereas reliance on aid as a primary source of income has increased. In the coastal areas, fishing activities continue to be limited by the ongoing conflict, loss of fishing assets and infrastructure and shortage and high prices of fuel. Income from fishing is also limited by the blockage of fish exports, according to the FSIS.

Remittance transfers continue to operate in Abyan but they are increasingly difficult to obtain. International remittances agencies like Western Union and MoneyGram are no longer operational in the governorate offices. Additionally, caps were placed on remittances and money transfer payouts; all transfers over 500,000 YER [1,275.50 USD] cannot be paid in one installment. Interviewed specialists also indicated that remittances agents in Abyan are operating out of their homes and imposing an "illegal tax" by withholding on average 1,000 YER per transaction as an informal commission rate. Rural residents without recourse to such traders must travel to the nearest city to collect or send a remittance. This is an exceptional burden given high fuel costs: a trip to the city to collect remittances was reported as costing between 750-6,000 YER depending on the journey

Humanitarian assistance

Obstructions to the distribution of humanitarian assistance appear to be minimal in Abyan. According to a data collection initiative by the Humanitarian Access Working Group (HAWG), which took place between 15-31 October, the humanitarian community in Yemen only reported one access constraint in Abyan (out of a total of 123 reported in the country), which was in the district of Khanfir. In January 2018, FSAC partners reached approximately 90 percent of their intended target in Abyan with emergency food assistance (211,692 individuals out of 235,606). Likewise, in December 2017, WFP reached approximately 90 percent of its intended target in Abyan by distributing 1926.51 MT of GFD to 195,058 beneficiaries in all of Abyan's districts with the exception of Ahwar. In general, ration sizes for assistance were estimated to cover approximately 60 percent of monthly beneficiary caloric needs. Since August, WFP assistance has covered about a third of the estimated half a million people (including IDPs) currently residing in Abyan governorate.

Food security indicator data

Food security outcome data suggests acute food insecurity remains severe in Abyan governorate. According to the October 2017 district-level famine risk monitoring data collected by FSAC partners in all of Abyan's districts, over 20 percent of the respondents had a poor FCS in 8 out of Abyan's 11 districts (Al Mahfad, Mudiya, Lawdar, Russud, Sarar, Al Wade, Ahwar and Khanfar). In addition, the mean rCSI was above 21 in the Mudiya and Russud districts.

Many livelihood coping strategies have already been exhausted. According to the October 2017 district-level famine risk monitoring data collected by FSAC partners in all of Abyan's districts, more than half of respondents indicated having exhausted livelihood coping strategies in the district of Zinjibar and most livelihood coping strategies in the districts of Al Mahfad, Mudiya, Lawdar, Sibah, Russud and Sarar. The possibility to sell productive assets was exhausted by over half of the respondents in 8 out of Abyan's 11 districts, the possibility to withdraw children from school in 7 out of Abyan's 11 districts, the possibility to borrow money in 6 out of Abyan's 11 districts and the possibility to sell household assets, consume seed stocks and sell a last female animal in 5 out of Abyan's 11 districts. Data from a rapid needs assessment in September 2017 in Rossod district shows that households are taking on debt to fill the gap between household expenditure and household income and meet their basic needs and are selling lands and household assets or livestock. Most households reported borrowing money to buy food.

Current food security outcomes

Based on available food security indicator data and contributing factor information, FEWS NET estimates that poor households in most areas of Abyan are likely facing elevated levels of acute food insecurity, including food consumption gaps, in line with Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) food insecurity. Given the magnitude of humanitarian assistance present in the zone, FEWS NET expects food security outcomes would likely be at least one phase worse in the absence of ongoing humanitarian assistance.

Given variations in conflict-levels and humanitarian access, it is likely that geographic variations in food security outcomes exist throughout the governorate. More specifically, IDPs throughout the governorate, poor households in conflict zones and poor households living in the coastal areas are likely facing the most severe outcomes.

Assumptions

- **Conflict and IDP Populations:** IDP populations will continue to increase with the intensification of the conflict on the western coast of Yemen and in the surrounding governorates.
- **Fishing:** Fishing activities on the coastal areas of Abyan will continue to be limited due to the ongoing security situation.
- **Agricultural production/labor:** Harvests of wheat will take place between February and March in livelihood zone YE-03 and harvests of sorghum and millet will take place between June and July in in livelihood zones YE-03 and YE-07. Agricultural labor income will increase in all livelihood zones in Abyan during the outlook period but will likely be below normal levels.
- **Staple food prices:** Staple food prices are expected to be remain higher than last year's and the 5-year average prices during the scenario period, in line with price trends at the key markets of supply in Aden.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Between February and May 2018, Abyan governorate is likely to be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) due to the presence of ongoing humanitarian assistance. In the absence of humanitarian assistance between June and September 2018, FEWS NET expects that food security outcomes would deteriorate in Abyan to Emergency (IPC Phase 4). IDP populations and those residing in conflict zones and in the coastal areas would continue to face some of the more severe outcomes. Even in the absence of additional disruptions, some affected populations are expected to face greater difficulty meeting their basic food needs as they begin to exhaust their coping capacity.

Al Hudaydah Governorate

Current Situation

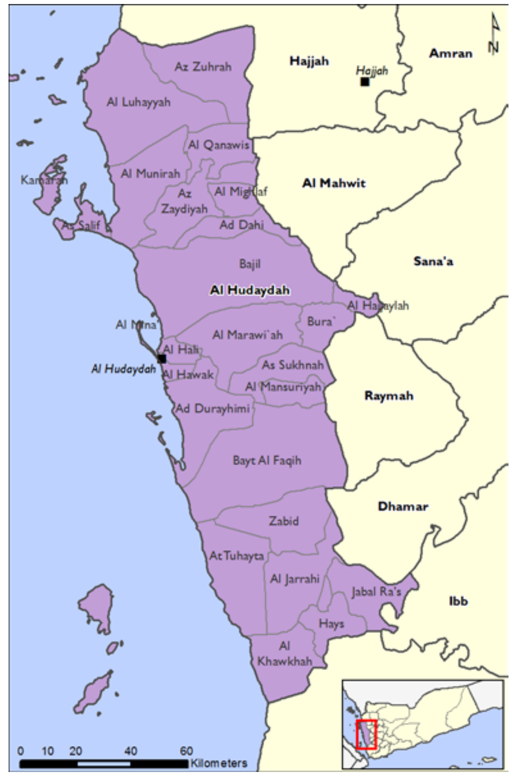
Conflict and displacement

The Task Force for Population Movement's 16th report indicates that, as of September 2017, there were 104,292 IDPs residing in Al Hudaydah, representing approximately 5 percent of the total population. As of September 2017, nearly 70,000 of all IDPs indicated Al Hudaydah as their governorate of origin. According to UNHCR's January update, about 1,500 households (10,200 individuals) fled conflict in Hays and Al Khowkha on Yemen's western coast since December to other parts of Al Hudaydah, and neighboring governorates of Ta'izz, Ibb, Dhamar. Moreover, 1,500 households (10,500 individuals) were estimated to have left for Aden, Abyan and Lahj. The assessments done by UNHCR and partners indicated that these households urgently need food,

shelter and household items, as well as nutrition, health care and sanitation support. Reports indicate further displacement continued in February.

The security situation in the southern part of Al Hudaydah Governorate remains tense and instable. Active conflict is most often reported in Al Tuhayta, Hays, and the main road to Al Garrahi district. According to OCHA, partners reported about 4,107 families displaced from the conflict areas districts through February 22nd. Most civilian incidents and casualties were caused by airstrikes.

Figure 8. Reference Map for Al Hudaydah Governorate



Source: *FEWS NET*

Trade, markets, and prices

Red sea ports are open to commercial and humanitarian imports. On November 6th, the Saudi-led coalition announced the closure of all seaports (including Al Hudaydah and Al Salif ports), airports, and land crossings into Yemen. The lifting of the blockade for Red Sea ports did not occur until December 20th, when the coalition announced the temporary suspension of the blockade by an initial 30 days, and then again in January for another 30 days. Although the temporary suspension has expired, the blockade does not appear to have been reinstated. FEWS NET monitoring of ship tracking data indicates that number of bulk carriers arriving at port of Al Hudaydah and Salif during the months of October to December 2017 was an average 7 ships per month, compared to an average of 11 ships per month arriving between October and December 2014.

UNVIM indicated in January that 25 vessels were cleared and discharged 415,255 MT of goods in Yemen's Red Sea ports, which represents a 10 percent increase compared to December 2017; 262,580 MT of the discharge was noted to be food and 119,612 MT was noted as fuel, a 37 percent decrease for food and a 48 percent decrease for fuel compared to October 2017, the month before the blockade.

WFP reports that wheat flour in December 2017 and January 2018 was "sparsely available" in Al Hudaydah. Additionally, wheat flour prices were 200 YER/kg, 46 percent higher than pre-conflict levels and five percent higher than December 2017.

Household livelihoods and incomes

Field reports from FAO suggest incomes from crop production are likely below average due to the persistently high cost of agricultural inputs (including fuel for irrigation pumps prolonged insecurity). Grains, fruits, and vegetables are the primary cash crops in Al Hudaydah. Livestock were also an integral part of household livelihoods in a typical year, providing milk and meat for consumption, and livestock sales for income. Agriculture in the two rural livelihood zones in the governorate (YE-11 and YE-14) is both rained and wadi-irrigated dependent. According to a January FAO assessment, the main challenges to livestock ownership were the high price of fodder, lack of water, lack of veterinary services, and security restrictions to movement for households seeking to bring their livestock to areas with better pasture. According to an assessment done by FAO in January, on the IPDs in Al-Jarahi, Jabal Rass, and Hays districts, almost all households interviewed still had livestock.

A Save the Children assessment in November 2017 noted that among 299 beneficiaries in Bajil and Zaidia districts in Al Hudaydah, the main reported sources of income were pensions (53.9%), fishing (10.4%), livestock sales (8.7%), social or relief aid (5.7%), and remittances (5.4%). Moreover, ACF rapid assessments to Al Khawkhah and Hays districts in December 2017 and Bayt Al-Faqih district in January 2018 indicate displaced households are highly dependent on gifts from the host community and humanitarian assistance.

Humanitarian assistance

Insecurity in Al Hudaydah continues to pose a threat to humanitarian operations in the governorate. Operating constraints are related to the restriction of movement, violence against humanitarian personnel, assets and facilities, and interference in the implementation of humanitarian activities.

On average, WFP reached more than 750,000 beneficiaries monthly in the last quarter of 2017, reaching more than 20 percent of the total population of the governorate. Approximately 450,000 beneficiaries received food in-kind and 300,000 voucher assistance. Similar levels of targeting are expected to have continued into 2018.

Food security and nutrition indicator data

Food security indicator data suggest acute food insecurity remains severe in Al Hudaydah governorate. According to WFP's mVAM data, between November 2017 and January 2018, approximately 19 percent of households had a poor FCS, somewhat similar compared to the six months prior and last year. Median rCSI also remained stable compared to six months ago and to last year. An ACF assessment in January 2018 among IDPs in Bayt Al-Faqih district found that approximately 90 percent of households had a poor FCS.

The primary results of the recent Famine Risk Monitoring assessments, implemented by FSAC, indicated that 44 percent of households have poor FCS and 28 percent have borderline FCS. The mean rCSI of 24 is higher than six months prior.

According to the UNICEF the SAM and MAM admissions into CMAM are the highest in Al Hudaydah governorate compared to other governorates, with a total of 69,705 cases of SAM and 100,898 of MAM in 2017. Moreover, data for the MUAC screening campaign that was done by the MoPHP and UNICEF in October 2017 found among the screened population in Al Hudaydah 6.2 percent SAM and 14.7 percent MAM. The campaign covered all district of Al Hudaydah and 57 percent of the total children between 6-59 of the total population. As of February 25th, there were 156,630 suspected cases of cholera in Al Hudaydah and 282 deaths reported.

Health facilities indicated that the nutritional status of children was currently worse than in 2014. Key informants indicate malnutrition is more widespread than in February 2015. Moreover, interviewed nutrition professionals confirm the nutritional status of children under five years of age as poor or extremely poor due to households' inability to purchase both adequate amounts of food as well as diverse enough foods to meet basic nutritional needs.

Current food security outcomes

Based on available information on food security outcomes and contributing factor information on household food availability and access, FEWS NET estimates that poor households in most areas of Al Hudaydah are likely facing elevated levels of food insecurity, including food consumption gaps, in line with Crisis (IPC Phase 3) food insecurity. Given variations in conflict-levels and humanitarian access, it is likely that geographic variations in food security outcomes exist throughout the governorate. More specifically, IDPs throughout the governorate and households in conflict zones in southern and western districts are facing the most severe food security outcomes.

Assumptions

The most likely scenario for the February to September 2018 period is based on the following zone-level assumptions:

- **Conflict**: Continued airstrikes and ground conflict are likely to increase civil insecurity and access to markets in the southern and western coastal area and will limit access to all livelihood activities.
- **IDP populations:** IDP populations are likely to increase due to the current fighting in the southern and western coastal area.
- **Agricultural production/labor**: Harvesting of cereals will take place between June and July in YE-11 and YE-14. Agricultural labor income will increase in these livelihood zones during this period but will likely be below normal levels.

- **Livestock and livestock products**: Among rural populations, sales of livestock are likely to continue throughout the outlook period, although terms of trade will be below normal. Livestock sale will increase in June and August as two major Muslim holidays occur during this time. Milk production will be near normal and increase between March to May and July to October in most areas in YE-11 and YE-14.
- **Imports of main commodities:** Wheat and fuel imports into Al Hudaydah and Salif will continue and ports will remain open despite potential further future restrictions on imports and the escalating fighting, although import levels are expected to remain low.
- **Fishing:** Fishing activities in coastal areas of Al Hudaydah will remain limited due to the ongoing security situation.
- **Staple food prices**: Staple food prices will likely continue to be higher than normal on the markets in Al Hudaydah and more volatile than in other key markets of supply, due to insecurity and high transportation costs.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

No significant improvements to food security conditions are expected in Al Hudaydah if conflict continues. **Between February and September 2018, Al Hudaydah governorate is likely to remain in Crisis (IPC Phase 3).** IDP populations and those residing in southern and western conflict-affected areas are likely to continue to face more severe outcomes. Even in the absence of additional disruptions, some affected populations are expected to face greater difficulty meeting their basic food needs as they begin to exhaust their coping capacity.

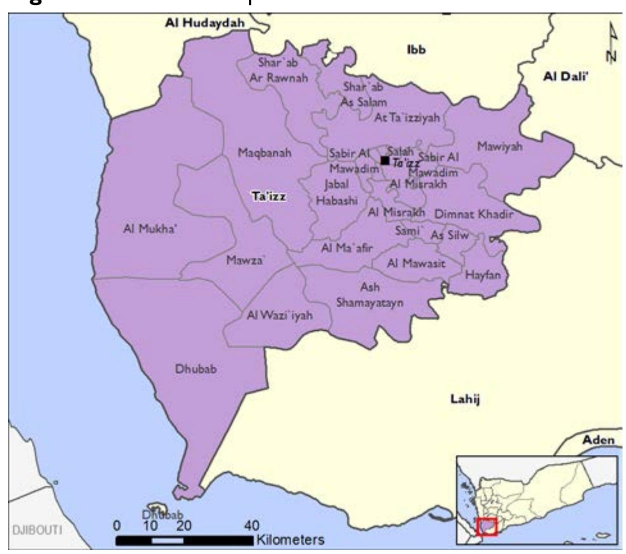
Ta'izz Governorate

Current Situation

Conflict and displacement

Fighting in Ta'izz continues, with Ta'izz city and Jabal Habashy, Sabir Al Mawadim, Al Maqbanah and Al Wazyiah districts experiencing fierce armed clashes and shelling. The road connecting Ibb and Ta'izz Governorates through Al Misrakh district has been reopened after a temporary closure due to clashes and bombardments. According to the Protection Cluster March 2018 update Ta'izz was the most affected governorate in terms of casualties in 2017.

Figure 9. Reference Map for Ta'izz Governorate



Source: *FEWS NET*

The Task Force for Population Movement's 16th report indicates that Ta'izz has the second highest number of IDPs in Yemen, and as of September 2017, there were 316,440 IDPs residing in Ta'izz, representing an 11 percent increase since the 15th TFPM report. IDPs in Ta'izz represent more than 10 percent of the total population of the governorate, and account for 16 percent of IDPs in Yemen. As of September 2017, Ta'izz is also the top governorate of origin of IDPs.

Trade, markets, and prices

Reports suggest Ta'izz is among the governorates for which transport access is worst in Yemen. Based on the Logistic Cluster constraints map in January, all routes in Mawza, Al Wazi'iyah, Maqbanah, Shara'b Ar Rawnah, At Ta'iziyah, Al Ma'afer, Al Mawasit, Ash Shamayatayn and Dhubab to As Suwayd are difficult to access. Jirdan to Dhubab, Mocha to Al-Ma'afer/ Mawza and all Al- Qahirah routes inside the city are closed. The Logistics Cluster mapping does suggest road access between Ta'izz City and Sana'a City (via Ibb) is also difficult, which affects trade into the governorate. The Port of Al Mokha is operational but sees relatively little traffic. Moreover, the ongoing siege of Ta'izz city still interrupts the flow of goods in and out of the city. Traders indicated that the current security situation has blocked off roads and prevented traders from purchasing or selling staple food stocks in the governorate.

WFP reports that wheat flour and fuel in December 2017 and January 2018 were “sparsely available” on markets in Ta’izz. Three months prior, wheat was reported as widely available. The availability of essential commodities remains constrained by trade that is restricted by conflict, high transaction costs, and recently the closure of key supply ports in Yemen.

In January 2018, WFP reported wheat flour and fuel prices increased compared to December 2017 and pre-crisis levels. Wheat flour was 250 YER/kg, more than 80 percent higher than pre-conflict levels, and 11 percent higher than December 2017. Petrol prices increased 3 percent over December prices and were more than 140 percent higher than pre-crisis levels.

Household livelihoods and incomes

Field reports suggest incomes from crop production are below average due to the persistently high cost of agricultural inputs (including fuel for irrigation pumps). Cereals, qat, and vegetables remain the major cash crops in Ta’izz, as was the case prior to the current conflict. Agriculture is both rainfed and wadi-irrigated dependent. Seasonal rainfall typically occurs between March and September with peaks in May and August. Households would typically be dependent on agricultural activities and livestock for income. Conflict continues to severely constrain agricultural activities in the governorate.

Humanitarian assistance and market purchase are among the top sources of food in the governorate. Market purchase is more frequently being funded on credit, with households reporting significant declines in the availability of cash incomes. A CARE assessment in As Shamaitan, Sama, and Al Maefer districts during the 2nd week of October 2017 showed that the main source of income across the surveyed districts during the previous 30 days was casual labor and humanitarian assistance. More than five percent of respondents indicated not having any income during the previous 30 days.

Humanitarian assistance

Insecurity along major transit routes to and from Ta’izz continues to pose a threat to humanitarian operations in the governorate. Operating constraints are related to the restriction of movement, violence against humanitarian personnel, assets and facilities, and interference in the implementation of humanitarian activities.

On average, WFP reached more nearly one million beneficiaries monthly in the last quarter of 2017, reaching more than 30 percent of the total population of the governorate. Approximately 665,000 beneficiaries received food in-kind and 285,000 voucher assistance. Unfortunately, due to the ongoing insecurity and a disagreement between local authorities on the caseload the food voucher distribution was cancelled for December. The districts that were not covered between October and December 2017 are Jabal Habashi, Mashra'a Wa Hadnan, Sabir Al Mawadim and Al Misrakh districts. Food distributions resumed in Al-Mudhaffar and Al-Qahirah districts in February, but at the same time were interrupted in Al-Taizyiah District by local communities due to the dissatisfaction with the distribution coverage. Similar levels of targeting in other districts are expected to have continued into 2018.

Food security and nutrition indicator data

Food security indicator data suggest acute food insecurity remains severe in Ta’izz governorate. According to WFP’s mVAM data collection, between November 2017 and January 2018, 29.8 percent of respondent households had a poor FCS, a level lower than the previous six months and last year. On the other hand, median rCSI remained stable compared to six months ago and last year. A CARE assessment in November 2017 indicated that 23 percent of households had poor FCS, and the median rCSI was 13. The primary results of the recent Famine Risk Monitoring assessments, implemented by the FSAC, indicated that half of households have a poor FCS in Ta’izz and the median rCSI is 18.

According to UNICEF, SAM and MAM admissions to CMAM programs in Ta’izz governorate are considered to be among the highest of all governorates. A total of 18,723 cases of SAM and 32,406 of MAM were reported in 2017. A MUAC screening that was conducted by the MoPHP and UNICEF in October 2017 found among the screened population in Ta’izz 2percent had SAM and 6.6 percent MAM. The campaign covered all districts of Ta’izz and 78 percent of total children between 6-59 months. Additionally, there were 64,731 suspected cases and 189 deaths from cholera as of February 25, 2018 in Ta’izz.

Current food security outcomes

Based on available information on food security outcomes and contributing factor information, FEWS NET estimates that poor households in most areas of Ta'izz are likely facing elevated levels of food insecurity, including food consumption gaps, in line with Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) food insecurity. Given the magnitude of humanitarian assistance present in the zone, FEWS NET expects that food security outcomes would likely be at least one phase worse in the absence of ongoing humanitarian assistance.

Given variations in conflict-levels and humanitarian access, it is likely that geographic variations in food security outcomes exist throughout the governorate. More specifically, IDPs throughout the governorate, poor households in inaccessible parts Ta'izz governorate, and poor households in lowland areas are worst-affected, where malnutrition levels have historically been high and increased in 2017 compared to pre-conflict levels.

Assumptions

The most likely scenario for the October 2017 to May 2018 period is based on the following zone-level assumptions:

- **Conflict**: Conflict is likely to continue at current levels, and will continue to limit access to livelihood activities including agro-pastoral work, formal employment and fishing.
- **IDP populations:** Further displacement at current rates is likely as military operations continue.
- **Agricultural production/labor:** Crop production is expected to be below average due to the lack of availability and/or access to inputs and limited access to fields in conflict zones. Harvests of qat will continue year-round but there will be a relative increase in agricultural labor income between June and September due to cereal harvests.
- **Livestock and livestock products:** Among rural populations, sales of livestock are likely to continue throughout the outlook period, although terms of trade will be below normal. Livestock sales will increase in June and August during the two major Muslim holidays. Milk production will be highest between March and May and July to October in YE-14 and May to June and September to November in YE-10.
- **Fishing:** Fishing activities in coastal areas of Ta'izz will remain limited due to the ongoing security situation.
- **Staple food prices:** Staple food prices will continue to be higher than normal and more volatile than in key markets of supply, due to insecurity and high transportation costs.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Between February and September 2018, Ta'izz governorate is likely to remain in Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) as the presence of ongoing humanitarian assistance prevents a deterioration in food security outcomes. In the absence of humanitarian assistance between January 2018 and May 2018, FEWS NET expects that food security outcomes would deteriorate in Ta'izz to Emergency (IPC Phase 4). IDP populations and populations in lowland areas will continue to face some of the more severe outcomes.

EVENTS THAT MIGHT CHANGE THE OUTLOOK

Table 1. Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
National	The Yemen Central Bank receives external assistance to replenish its depleted reserves or it gains access to its foreign reserves currently frozen in overseas accounts	The Yemeni rial to US dollar exchange rate would become more stable and the Central Bank would start supporting again wheat flour importers, through lines of credit. This would contribute to the stabilization of import levels, local food availability, and food prices. In addition, government salaries, pensions and social welfare would be paid again, increasing household incomes and purchasing power and improving food security outcomes.
	Food imports stop completely due to, closure of the main ports, destruction of key port infrastructure or major changes in macroeconomic policies that prevent traders from accessing currency to fund their imports	Although informal trade across land borders would be likely, food availability at local markets would quickly decline. Food security outcomes would likely deteriorate with areas likely to deteriorate to Famine (IPC Phase 5) in a worst-case scenario.
	Intensification or reduction in conflict levels, or a change in the location of fighting/airstrikes	Changes in conflict could lead to either a deterioration or improvement in household livelihoods, market functioning, and humanitarian access. Food access would likely worsen if conflict became worse and would improve if a medium to long-term ceasefire were to occur. An increase in the intensity of conflict could also result in an increase of the number of IDPs which face the most severe food security outcomes.
	Increased humanitarian assistance levels	Additional humanitarian assistance could further mitigate food consumption gaps, reduce malnutrition, and excess mortality for poor households in areas of intervention.
	Remittance functioning is normalized including lifting instructions of the personal remittance and closed remittance offices are reopened resulting in facilitated access to remittances	Improved access to remittances will help to increase household incomes and household purchasing power resulting in increased local demand for food and improved food security outcomes.

ABOUT SCENARIO DEVELOPMENT

To project food security outcomes, FEWS NET develops a set of assumptions about likely events, their effects, and the probable responses of various actors. FEWS NET analyzes these assumptions in the context of current conditions and local livelihoods to arrive at a most likely scenario for the coming eight months. Learn more here.